and

I'll stand by my version.

8 Lester del Rey and I are a lot like that, too.

In fact, I was sorry I had finished the book, and I was therefore intent on writing another one of the sort—but not right away, for the second edition of the textbook was in high gear.

Till now I had been collecting new chemical findings that would require revision and expansion of the text, but now Williams & Wilkins had sent us large versions of the book with blank pages in between every pair of printed pages. I made notes, revisions, and reference notations on those blank pages opposite the places where revisions and expansions would have to be made. It ate up a lot of time.

Meanwhile, the October 1953 Astounding came out with "Belief," 4 and the October 1953 Galaxy came out with the first of the three parts into which The Caves of Steel had been divided for serial purposes. Not only that, but also (at my suggestion) F & SF had agreed to reprint my story "The Fun They Had." On this occasion, I heard from the magazine's new managing editor, Robert P. Mills, who wrote to suggest lunch.

Much less pleasant than any of this was the fact that McGraw-Hill was showing definite interest in the student-nurse textbook. They had a woman, M. Kolaya Nicholas, who was working on such a book but who felt she needed help. McGraw-Hill thought we might help her and, worse, Walker thought we might—so I was stuck with it.

17

I drove into New York late in October to oblige Sam Moskowitz, who by now (and ever since) was a good friend of mine. He was giving a class in science fiction at City College 5 and wanted me as guest lecturer. The trip was noteworthy since we finally dared leave David in the back seat alone. (It was a two-door car; he could not get out.)

I gave my two-hour talk to Sam's class on October 23, 1953. I remember very little about it except that I drew detailed diagrams on the board to exemplify my notions of novel structure. Sam remembers it more glowingly than I do. He has never ceased bemoaning the fact that it never occurred to him to tape the talk.